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compact1, compact2, compact3

java.util

Class StringJoiner

java.lang.Object
    java.util.StringJoiner

```
public final class StringJoiner
extends Object
```

`StringJoiner` is used to construct a sequence of characters separated by a delimiter and optionally starting with a supplied prefix and ending with a supplied suffix.

Prior to adding something to the `StringJoiner`, its `sj.toString()` method will, by default, return `prefix + suffix`. However, if the `setEmptyValue` method is called, the `emptyValue` supplied will be returned instead. This can be used, for example, when creating a string using set notation to indicate an empty set, i.e. `"{}"`, where the `prefix` is `"{"`, the `suffix` is `"}"` and nothing has been added to the `StringJoiner`.

API Note:

The String "[George:Sally:Fred]" may be constructed as follows:

```
StringJoiner sj = new StringJoiner(":", "[", "]");
sj.add("George").add("Sally").add("Fred");
String desiredString = sj.toString();
```

A StringJoiner may be employed to create formatted output from a Stream using Collectors.joining(CharSequence). For example:

```
List<Integer> numbers = Arrays.asList(1, 2, 3, 4);
String commaSeparatedNumbers = numbers.stream()
```

```
    .map(i -> i.toString())
    .collect(Collectors.joining(", "));
```

Since:

1.8

See Also:

`Collectors.joining(CharSequence)`, `Collectors.joining(CharSequence, CharSequence, CharSequence)`

Constructor Summary

Constructors

Constructor	D
`StringJoiner(CharSequence delimiter)`	C S v c i p s c s c
`StringJoiner(CharSequence delimiter, CharSequence prefix, CharSequence suffix)`	C S v c i c s p c a

Method Summary

Concrete Methods

Modifier and Type	Method	Description
`StringJoiner`	`add(CharSequence newElement)`	Adds a copy of the given CharSequence

		value as the next element of the `StringJoiner` value.
`int`	**`length`**`()`	Returns the length of the `String` representation of this `StringJoiner`.
`StringJoiner`	**`merge`**`(`**`StringJoiner`** `other)`	Adds the contents of the given `StringJoiner` without prefix and suffix as the next element if it is non-empty.
`StringJoiner`	**`setEmptyValue`**`(`**`CharSequence`** `emptyValue)`	Sets the sequence of characters to be used when determining the string representation of this `StringJoiner` and no elements have been added yet, that is, when it is empty.
`String`	**`toString`**`()`	Returns the current value, consisting of the `prefix`, the values added so far separated by the `delimiter`, and the

		`suffix`, unless no elements have been added in which case, the `prefix + suffix` or the `emptyValue` characters are returned

Methods inherited from class java.lang.Object

`clone`, `equals`, `finalize`, `getClass`, `hashCode`, `notify`, `notifyAll`, `wait`, `wait`, `wait`

Constructor Detail

StringJoiner

```
public StringJoiner(CharSequence delimiter)
```

Constructs a `StringJoiner` with no characters in it, with no `prefix` or `suffix`, and a copy of the supplied `delimiter`. If no characters are added to the `StringJoiner` and methods accessing the value of it are invoked, it will not return a `prefix` or `suffix` (or properties thereof) in the result, unless `setEmptyValue` has first been called.

Parameters:

`delimiter - the sequence of characters to be used between each element added to the StringJoiner value`

Throws:

`NullPointerException - if delimiter is null`

StringJoiner

```
public StringJoiner(CharSequence delimiter,
                    CharSequence prefix,
                    CharSequence suffix)
```

Constructs a `StringJoiner` with no characters in it using copies of the supplied `prefix`, `delimiter` and `suffix`. If no characters are added to the `StringJoiner` and methods accessing the string value of it are invoked, it will return the `prefix + suffix` (or properties thereof) in the result, unless `setEmptyValue` has first been called.

Parameters:

`delimiter - the sequence of characters to be used between each element added to the StringJoiner`

`prefix - the sequence of characters to be used at the beginning`

`suffix - the sequence of characters to be used at the end`

Throws:

`NullPointerException - if prefix, delimiter, or suffix is null`

Method Detail

setEmptyValue

`public StringJoiner setEmptyValue(CharSequence emptyValue)`

Sets the sequence of characters to be used when determining the string representation of this `StringJoiner` and no elements have been added yet, that is, when it is empty. A copy of the `emptyValue` parameter is made for this purpose. Note that once an add method has been called, the `StringJoiner` is no longer considered empty, even if the element(s) added correspond to the empty `String`.

Parameters:

`emptyValue - the characters to return as the value of an empty StringJoiner`

Returns:

`this StringJoiner itself so the calls may be chained`

Throws:

`NullPointerException - when the emptyValue parameter is null`

toString

```
public String toString()
```

Returns the current value, consisting of the `prefix`, the values added so far separated by the `delimiter`, and the `suffix`, unless no elements have been added in which case, the `prefix + suffix` or the `emptyValue` characters are returned

Overrides:

`toString` in class `Object`

Returns:

the string representation of this StringJoiner

add

```
public StringJoiner add(CharSequence newElement)
```

Adds a copy of the given `CharSequence` value as the next element of the `StringJoiner` value. If `newElement` is `null`, then `"null"` is added.

Parameters:

`newElement` - The element to add

Returns:

a reference to this StringJoiner

merge

```
public StringJoiner merge(StringJoiner other)
```

Adds the contents of the given `StringJoiner` without prefix and suffix as the next element if it is non-empty. If the given `StringJoiner` is empty, the call has no effect.

A `StringJoiner` is empty if `add()` has never been called, and if `merge()` has never been called with a non-empty `StringJoiner` argument.

If the other `StringJoiner` is using a different delimiter, then elements from the other `StringJoiner` are concatenated with that delimiter and the result is appended to this `StringJoiner` as a single element.

Parameters:

`other` - The StringJoiner whose contents should be merged into this one

Returns:

This StringJoiner

Throws:

`NullPointerException` - if the other StringJoiner is null

length

`public int length()`

Returns the length of the `String` representation of this `StringJoiner`. Note that if no add methods have been called, then the length of the `String` representation (either `prefix + suffix` or `emptyValue`) will be returned. The value should be equivalent to `toString().length()`.

Returns:

the length of the current value of StringJoiner

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